CHAPTER 12

Preparing for Production

Ever heard the culinary term *mise en place*? Translated literally, it means *everything in its place*; it refers to the prep work done before actually starting to cook. I've watched enough *Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares* to know that no self-respecting chef begins without it. Similarly, eager as we are to see our app running in production, there are a few preliminaries to take care of first.

In this chapter, we'll lay the groundwork for deploying to production, starting with how to configure different environments in a Docker-centric world. We'll also precompile our assets and bake them into our image, ready to be served up in production.

Finally, we'll learn how to share our custom images to make them available for use beyond our local machine.

Chopping board and peeler at the ready? Let's get to it.

Configuring a Production Environment

Rails pioneered out-of-the-box support for multiple environments. How does this fit in with our Docker setup? We know that our production config will differ from that in development, but what settings do we need and how do we organize things?

Previously, we created the following file structure for our config:

```
$ tree .env
.env
└── development
    ├── database
    └── web

1 directory, 2 files
```